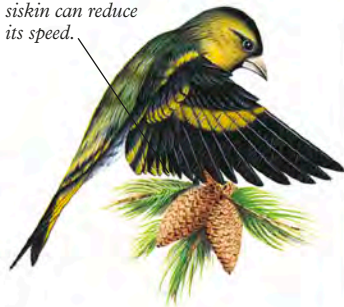




### Starved out

Every few years, winter is even colder than usual. When this happens, the crossbills and waxwings leave the cold forest to feed in warmer woods.

*By opening up its feathers, the siskin can reduce its speed.*



### Cone-opener

Crossbills' beaks can snip open cones a bit like a can opener. Red crossbills eat spruce seeds, but bigger species can open up large pine cones.



Larch cone



Spruce cone



Pine cone



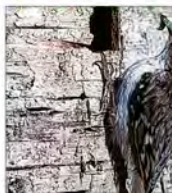
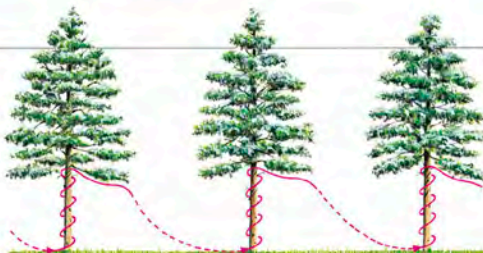
Inside a cone

Woody scale

Tasty seed



*This greenish-brown bird is a female red crossbill—only the males are red!*



### Up and over

Like a little feathered mouse, the treecreeper creeps up tree trunks looking for spiders and earwigs to eat. It starts at the bottom of the tree, spirals its way up the trunk, walks along the first big branch, and then drops down to the bottom of the next tree.

### Touchdown

Birds have to slow down to land, but, just like planes, if they go too slowly they can stall and fall out of the sky. By sticking out their alula, they can change the flow of the wind over their body and avoid crash-landings!